Instructional Note (for Proponents)

(This section is NOT part of the consent form given to participants)

This Informed Consent Form template is provided as a guide to ensure that all required ethical elements are included.

In the final version given to participants, the information below must be presented in clear, complete sentences and paragraphs, written in language appropriate to the participant's level of understanding.

Checklist items, prompts, and bracketed instructions in this template are for guidance only and should not appear in the version signed by participants.

The final consent form should read as a continuous document that explains the study, participation, risks, benefits, confidentiality, and rights of participants in a clear and understandable manner.

Informed Consent Form for (PARTICIPANTS)

This informed consent form is for (PARTICIPANTS) for the (Thesis/ Capstone Project) titled

(TITLE OF PROJECT)

We are (undergraduate/ graduate) students of (Course) of the FEU Institute of Technology. We are conducting this (interview/survey/focus group discussion/ others (state specifically)) as part of our (Capstone/ Thesis/dissertation) titled **(TITLE OF PROJECT)**.

We are inviting you to be part of our study. Your participation in this study is **voluntary**. You may choose not to participate or to withdraw at any time, without penalty or negative consequences. Please take time to think about whether you would like to participate. You may also withdraw your participation at any time during the project.

Please read this consent form carefully. If anything is unclear, or if you have questions, please feel free to ask us to explain before deciding whether to participate. It is important that you understand the purpose of the study, what your participation involves, and your rights as a participant.

(Note: Please change this portion if you are going to explain to your participants directly instead of letting them read. Please note that this may only be used if the participant is of legal age. Otherwise, this should be signed by the guardian and an assent form will be signed by the minor.)

Purpose of the Study

*(Briefly describe the purpose of the study in **clear, non-technical language**.)*

This study is being conducted as part of our academic requirement at FEU Institute of Technology.

Participant Selection
You are being invited to participate because (state reason clearly - qualifications, experience, role, or random selection).

Nature of Participation

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to take part in the following activity or activities:

(Describe clearly, in complete sentences, what the participant will experience. Include the type of activity, the general topic, whether it is individual or group-based, whether it will be recorded, and the estimated duration.)

For example, your description should explain:

- What you will do (e.g., complete a survey, join an interview, test a system, participate in a discussion, appear in a creative output)
- What the activity is about (general topic in non-technical language)
- How long it will take
- Whether audio, video, screen recording, or observation will occur
- Whether participation is individual or with others

Your participation will involve:

If recording (audio, video, image, or screen capture) is involved, this will be clearly explained before the activity begins, and your permission will be obtained.

During interviews or discussions, follow-up questions may be asked based on your responses. However, all questions will remain related to the general topic of the study described above.

You may skip any question or stop the activity at any time if you feel uncomfortable.

Duration and Location

The study will take place over approximately (duration). (If the activity involves more than one session, please state as well.)

Participation will occur at (physical location, through an online or remote platform)

(If travel or additional costs are required, state if you have provisions, remove if not necessary).

Your participation is entirely voluntary. Any data or information obtained from you will not be used against you. The results of this study may be presented as a research paper but all identifying information will not be included without your written permission.

Risks and Discomforts
The study involves (risk level: **minimal risk**, meaning no greater risk than those encountered in everyday activities/ no risk/ others)

(Possible risks or discomforts may include: e.g., time commitment, mild discomfort, exposure in media, or online participation.)

(To minimize these risks, state what can be done, including: stop participating at any time, stopping the activity, confidentiality measures to safeguard data.)

Benefits

(State benefits that the participant can receive from participating in this study. You may include what the study is for, but it has to be a benefit for the participant.)

Note: Compensation, if any, is not considered a benefit.

Voluntary Participation and Withdrawal

Your participation is voluntary. You may choose not to participate without penalty. You may withdraw from the study at any time without negative consequences.

If you withdraw, any data that can still be linked to you will not be used, where feasible. Please note that If data have already been anonymized and cannot be identified, they may no longer be removable.

You may also request to review or clarify information you provided, where applicable.

Confidentiality and Data Protection
All information collected in this study will be handled confidentially. Your name or other direct identifiers will not appear in reports or publications without written permission. Data will be stored securely and accessed only by (e.g. research team including advisers, panel members). Results will be reported in aggregate form whenever possible.
If audio, video, images, or creative outputs are involved, you will be informed separately of how these materials will be used and presented.
Data will be retained only for the period necessary for academic or research purposes and will be disposed of securely thereafter.

Focus Group Confidentiality (Delete if Not Applicable)

If you are participating in a focus group discussion, please be aware that while the researchers will keep all information confidential, we cannot guarantee that other participants will do the same.

We will remind all participants at the beginning of the session to respect the privacy of others and not to share any information discussed during the focus group outside the session.

However, because other participants will hear what you say, complete confidentiality cannot be guaranteed in a group setting. You are encouraged to share only what you are comfortable discussing in the presence of others.

Use of Images, Voice, or Creative Outputs (delete if not applicable)
This study involves audio recordings, video recordings, images, or creative representation:

By signing this form, you acknowledge that:

- You understand how your image, voice, or likeness may be used for the purposes of this study.
- You have been informed where and how the outputs may be presented (e.g., classroom presentation, academic exhibit, online sharing).
- You understand that digital materials may remain stored or displayed beyond the duration of the study.

If you do not agree to media use, you may inform the researcher. Alternative arrangements, where feasible, will be discussed.

Contact Information

If you have questions about the study, you may contact:

Name of Principal Investigator: _____
Contact Information: _____

Faculty Adviser: _____
Contact Information: _____

If you have concerns about your rights as a participant, or wish to speak to someone independent of the research team, you may contact:

FEU Institute of Technology
Institutional Research Ethics Review Committee (IREC)
Email: research@feutech.edu.ph

CERTIFICATE OF CONSENT
I have read this consent form, or it has been read to me. I have had the opportunity to ask questions, and all my questions have been answered to my satisfaction.
I understand that:

- I will receive a copy of this consent form
- My participation is voluntary
- I may withdraw at any time without penalty

By signing below, I voluntarily agree to participate in this study.

Printed Name of Participant: _____
Signature: _____
Date (MM/DD/YYYY): _____

Impartial Witness Statement

(To be completed only if the participant is unable to sign or requires assistance)
I confirm that the consent form was accurately read to the participant, that questions were answered, and that consent was given freely.
Printed Name of Witness: _____
Signature: _____
Date: _____

Statement of Researcher
I confirm that I have explained the study to the participant, answered all questions honestly, and obtained consent without coercion.

Printed Name of Researcher/s: _____
Signature: _____
Date: _____